

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

to answer all readers' letters by e-mail: we simply do not have the time and career experts-on-call to reply to almost 100 such mails a day we get from our readers!

— Executive Editor

Free!

Instead of lot of trial versions, if you give only one full-version software with a license key, it would be absolutely useful for us *Digit* readers. Like ZoneAlarm, WinZip, Nero, etc., are useful to everyone. If you bought a multi-user license, and gave it to your readers, it would not amount to piracy. It will at least reduce 10 per cent of piracy!

S Narayanan
Chennai

Dear Mr Narayanan,
If only we could give you many more full-version software! But all software companies have their commercial interests to look after, and they do not let us give full versions. We do constantly try and secure deals with new and upcoming software companies to give their latest products on our CD/DVD, and let our readers test and try out their new creations. While some do agree to it, others prefer to sell every single copy of it in the market.

— Executive Editor

Shoot Those Boards

It seems you are off track: I was expecting a motherboard test for the past six months, but I guess you are now a multi-purpose magazine for everyone. I like that you cover all areas of IT, but I request you to add special pages on motherboards. Or, you can give us a *Fast Track* on motherboards plus BIOS. I also want to tell you that till date, you have not answered my letters in the magazine!

Sukhwinder Singh Sandhu
Muktsar, Punjab

Dear Sukhwinder,
Our Test Centre annual calendar always slots a particular category of computer components or gadgets once a year, and tests them thoroughly. Since there are so many products to test, we do not repeat them in one calendar year, but yes—new models are tested throughout the year in our *Bazaar* section. For instance, this month we have reviewed a motherboard, while next month, we plan to carry a big, long motherboard shoot-out.

Age-no-bar!

I am over fifty and a self-taught hobbyist

programmer. I know some C/C++, VB6, and am now trying my hand at Web programming with PHP & ASP.NET (this one is really tough!). Too ambitious at this age, you might wonder, but believe me, I simply love it. EasyPHP is really great. I had to download it though, because of the DVD not working. Thanks again for your wonderful magazine and those lovely *Fast Track* booklets.

Ranjan Mitra

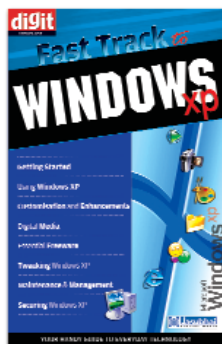
Dear Mr Mitra,
It is indeed remarkable that at age 50 you have taken up the challenge of learning so much about computing and programming. In the past, too, we've received some letters from senior citizens who are charmed by *Digit* and are educating themselves in the technology realm. Age is, as we can see, no barrier to learning, and our country's IT potential will, for sure, leave the world behind.

We're glad to be able to assist you in a small manner and to have fuelled your passion. Keep it going!

— Executive Editor

Reliving The Past

Your September Edition was very useful: your review of digital cameras helped me pick one for myself. The *Fast Track* to Security was superb, and I am now able to secure my PC from hacking, viruses, spyware, and adware. Security on the network was awesome as well. If possible, give a *Fast Track* to Windows XP in the next edition.



Yash Aryan

Dear Yash,
We have already given a *Fast Track* to Windows XP with our February 2006 issue, but don't fret if you've missed it. Just wait for a few months—we plan to give our previous *Fast Tracks* as PDFs on our December 2006 DVD.

— Executive Editor

More About Piracy...

A lot of people have expressed their thoughts about piracy through past few issues of *Digit*. We have heard almost everything about so called piracy. While it was pleasing to know that most of *Digit's* readers are going for either paid software or freeware rather than pirated software. Still, it was just ridiculous to learn that some people still support the use of pirated software open-heartedly and the excuse given by them is mostly "Everybody is doing it, so why shouldn't I?" Just think of a day when rules are going to be strict and people supporting piracy are penalised, then how many of those great guys are going to say "Everyone is being punished so why shouldn't I?"

This is not a joke. We all know differences between original and pirated software. I know each and everyone cannot afford paid software, but we all can use free software and honestly most of them are as good as paid ones.

As far as the comment "Piracy creates potential customers" is concerned, I think that is just an excuse. Almost all software companies provide fully functional trial versions of their software, for a specified time, and the trial period is long enough for people to decide whether they want to buy or not.

The reason behind this piracy problem is the price of paid software. Software that costs an American double figures costs us in three figures. Whatever may be the cause, one thing we all know is that we cannot stop anyone from use pirated software against his/her own will. So what is the solution? Maybe it is the duty of software companies to fix their prices according to economy of a country.

Neeraj Singh

Your annoyance about this issue is quite justifiable. While there's really no cure for people who get their thrills using software worth lakhs for no money at all, the other camp still suffers the mental block that (1) Open Source is for the geek, and (2) Anything free just can't be good. As for expecting that software companies will set pricing according to the economy of the country, join us in dreaming on.

— Executive Editor

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH